Product context

1 Overview

Harbor & Pine wants to make it easier to discover, book and manage local activities. The proposed product combines a traveler experience, tools for guides and Operations, and an assistant before and during an activity. The initial pilot markets are Lisbon and Barcelona.

2 Starting point

The business already sells tours through a public website, staff and partner channels. It uses spreadsheets, email, messaging and separate support and payment tools. There is no shared product view across travelers, guides and Operations.

The client wants a new platform built from scratch and has asked not to show the current website as a design reference. This is not a decision to replace every operational tool, operator agreement or integration. Those dependencies still need assessment.

3 Problem framing

Travelers need to know what they are booking, whether it is confirmed, where to meet and what to do when plans change. Guides need current information with little extra administration. Operations needs to see problems early enough to act. The relative priority of these problems has not been validated.

4 Goals and possible measures

Business: increase completed bookings, reduce avoidable support questions and manual work, and prepare for future cities and hotel partners.

Experience: make booking easy to follow, keep critical day-of information available with a weak connection, and communicate changes clearly.

Possible measures include booking completion, support contacts per booking, manual handling time and guide adoption. Reliable baselines and target values have not been supplied.

5 Commercial phase

The current SOW covers 550 total hours across a Product Manager, Product Designer and Tech Lead for discovery, ideation, scope definition and high-fidelity design, with technical feasibility input. Development is a subsequent phase.

An eight-week pilot has been mentioned by the client. Its relationship to design completion, implementation and a live launch is not agreed.

Users and proposed booking scope

6 Main users

Traveler: browses and books, usually on a phone; one person may book for a group.

Guide: needs a schedule, group details, attendance and a way to request help.

Operations: handles assignments, changes, incidents, cancellations and refunds.

Operator: controls availability, prices, policies and activity delivery.

Hotel partner: recommends activities through a possible branded channel.

7 Product principles

Customers should see what the business can deliver. Ask only for necessary booking details. Critical day-of information should remain accessible with limited connectivity. Automation should reduce repetitive work. Important changes to paid bookings require human approval. Prepare for growth without trying to build the entire vision at once.

8 Candidate pilot scope

The following describes a proposed product direction. It is not an approved implementation backlog or a commitment that every item fits within the initial phase.

Browse and activity details

Compare activities by destination, date, interests, duration, language, price and accessibility. Show inclusions, restrictions, meeting point and cancellation terms.

Availability and booking

Show clear availability and expected total price. Connected inventory may confirm immediately. Other inventory requires operator approval after payment authorization. The customer experience should feel quick; how it communicates the wait remains open.

Guest checkout and booking access

An account is not required to book. Travelers should recover their itinerary on another device and share a group booking. A secure recovery mechanism and sharing permissions have not been selected.

Confirmation and voucher

Show booking status, voucher and instructions. Some operators check a reservation; others may need individual attendance. Internal statuses may be more detailed than customer-facing statuses. Mapping them needs definition.

Day of activity and experience requirements

Day-of experience

Open meeting-point instructions, voucher, support and updates without a required app download. Critical information should work with limited connectivity. The exact offline dataset and refresh behavior are not defined. The assistant may suggest alternatives; it must not change a paid booking without approval.

Guide experience

See schedule and group information, record attendance, report delays and request help. Work on older phones with little typing. Adoption and the relationship with existing messaging need research.

Operations experience

See booking status, review exceptions, contact the right people and approve changes. Keep existing tools where that is the simplest pilot approach. Exception ownership and escalation need agreement.

Hotel channel

A branded hotel experience is part of the future vision. Sales has requested early consideration; what, if anything, belongs in the pilot remains open.

9 Main traveler journey

Browse and compare; review key conditions; provide booking details and authorize payment; receive status and voucher; review preparation and meeting-point details; arrive and check in; complete the activity; receive follow-up and leave feedback.

Also consider manual confirmation, payment failure, weather, guide delays, weak connectivity, split group arrivals, cancellation and refunds. Which exceptions use product support versus a temporary manual process is not yet agreed.

10 Early business rules

The first displayed price should be close to the final price. Manual inventory requires operator approval. Cancellation rules may vary by activity. An account is not required to book. Share traveler data only as needed for activity delivery. Who approves each kind of paid-booking change still needs definition.

11 Language and accessibility

The pilot brief includes English and Spanish. Sales has requested additional languages for hotels; these are not confirmed pilot requirements. Main flows should meet WCAG 2.2 AA. Review and approval responsibilities are not assigned.

Dependencies and unresolved questions

12 Dependencies

Inventory providers, payments, maps and location services, messaging, translation, legal and privacy review, and access to guides and operators. No current-system audit has been completed.

13 Risks

Availability that appears confirmed before acceptance; automation that adds manual work; low guide adoption; incorrect assistant suggestions; different operator policies; unreliable connectivity; and pilot scope that exceeds the available phase.

14 Open questions

When can a manual booking be described as confirmed?

Which details must be available offline, and how are they updated?

How can a guest recover and share a booking safely?

What can the assistant suggest, and what can it execute?

Who approves changes and handles exceptions?

What belongs in the hotel channel, and which languages are included?

Which metrics have a reliable baseline?

Who approves accessibility and privacy requirements?

What does the eight-week expectation mean, and what implementation effort follows the current phase?

15 Pilot readiness proposal

A traveler should complete the main booking journey, a guide should manage the group and Operations should handle expected exceptions. The team still needs to agree acceptable manual effort, supported exceptions, temporary workarounds and launch criteria. These are proposed readiness conditions, not evidence that the pilot has been scoped or approved.